VIETNAM'S INDIAN AMBITION

VINFAST'S VF7 SUV PAIRS BOLD DESIGN WITH TECH-LADEN INTERIORS AND EV MUSCLE AHEAD OF ITS INDIA LAUNCH

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VinFast VF7
Motor: Dual-motor, AWD
Power: 354 bhp
Torque: 500Nm
Transmission: Single-speed
Battery: 70.8kWh, Li-ion phosphate
Range: 431 km (WLTP estimated)
Top speed: 200 kmph (est.)
Price: ₹30 lakh (est.)
On sale July 2025

VinFast, part of the Vietnamese conglomerate Vin-Group, will be launching two electric SUVs in India later this month. The VF6 and VF7 will be made in India at its new state-of-the-art plant in Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu.

We were in Vietnam to experience the two cars engineered for the Indian market at the company's sprawling mother plant in Haiphong, northern Vietnam. Here is what we think of the VF7, the larger and more premium of the two.

Unlike its smaller sibling, the VF7 has a much sharper design with more angles and a bit more flair, with a very pronounced sporty roof that slopes back a lot, resulting in a minimal glasshouse on a very chunky body. The front V signature is more upright and similar to the design at the rear, and both the tail lamp and the front DRLs are quite attractive and have a lot more panache than the VF6. The VF7 is shorter than the MG Hector and Mahindra XUV700 but is exactly the same width as the latter and not as tall.



The VF7 will be available in both FWD and AWD versions, with the former sharing the same 150kW motor as on the VF6, with an additional motor doing service at the rear on the AWD version. The power and torque figures on the AWD version would increase to 260kW and 500Nm, respectively. The 0-100 kmph acceleration times on the more powerful variant would come down to 5.8 seconds from 9.5 seconds for the FWD variant. The battery would also be larger, moving to 70.8kWh for both versions of the VF7. Though the MIDC (Modified Indian Drive Cycle) range is yet to be disclosed, one can see that in other markets, the VF7 has claimed a range of just